Frequently Asked Questions

General Information

Q: What is IDOL Hackathon?

- IDOL Hackathon's primary goal is to harness the creative and technological potential of young student-technologists. By encouraging innovative solutions, we aim to drive technological advancement and create meaningful impact. On its fourth year, it aims to raise awareness about the transformative role of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) in the energy utility industry.

Q: What does IDOL stand for?

- IDOL stands for Innovative, Digital, Original, Leading-edge, a series of events which brought together diverse talents for this hackathon event.

Q: Who can participate?

- Undergraduates (no existing bachelor's degree); and
- Enrolled senior high school and college students aged 18 and above (by date of application) from reputable educational institutions.
- Teams can have 2 to 5 members.

Q: Is there a registration fee?

- Participation to IDOL Hackathon is free! No payment shall be collected.

Q: When is the deadline for application?

- Deadline for application is on October 23, 2026, 11:59PM.

Q: What should be submitted to register participation in IDOL Hackathon?

  - Accomplished Team Application Form
  - Verification documents of all members (proof of enrollment or any equivalent documentation from school)
  - Signed TERMS and Privacy Notice and Consent
  - Project Proposal

Submit to: hackathon@meralcopoweracademy.org with the subject "IDOL HACKATHON 2026 PROPOSAL - (GROUPNAME)".

Q: When and where is the hackathon?

- Date: November 12 – November 13, 2026
- Location: Meralco Compound, Ortigas, Pasig City

Duration: The IDOL Hackathon Proper is a 2-day event. Qualified teams are expected to attend the orientation on the morning of November 11, 2026 and be ready for the 2-day Hackathon from November 12, 2026 to November 13, 2026.

Technical Details

Q: What resources will be provided?

- Internet connectivity
- Power outlets
- Specific hardware/software to be provided will be shared in more detail at a later time
- Coaches will be available for mentorship and support

Q: Can I start working on my project before the hackathon?

- Participants will receive the official hackathon challenge statements and choose one challenge to address during the hackathon.
- All source code must be written between November 12, 9:00 AM to November 13, 9:00 AM.
- Pre-existing libraries and frameworks are allowed

Q: Are AI tools and other coding assistance tools allowed?

- Yes. Participants may use AI tools, code generators, open-source libraries, frameworks, and other development aids, provided they understand their implementation and can explain how their solutions work. Participants must ensure that their use of these tools complies with applicable licenses, third-party intellectual property rights, and the hackathon's rules.

Rules & Judging

Q: What are the criteria for judging?

- Innovation (30%)
- Functionality (25%)
- Impact (20%)
- Technical Challenge (15%)
- Presentation (10%)

Q: What are the prizes?

- First Place: Php 100,000
- Second Place: Php 75,000
- Third Place: Php 50,000

Logistics

Q: What should I bring?

- Laptop and charger
- Student ID
- Personal items
- Other necessary items will be communicated at a later time.

Q: Are there prohibited items at the venue?

- Alcohol, cigarettes/vape, and all forms of illegal substances
- Single-Use Plastics (SUPs)

Support

Q: How can I get help during the event?

- Technical mentors will be available.
- There will be facilitators to reach out for any concern that you may have during the event.
- Designated first aid station and medical staff will be available on-site throughout the event. Participants should inform the event staff of any medical conditions or special needs that may require attention during the overnight stay.